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Pennsylvania

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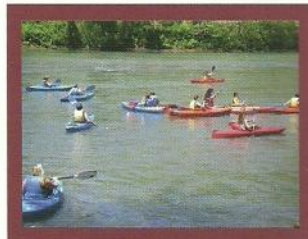
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Indiana County
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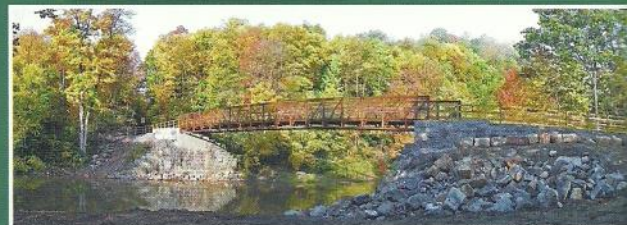
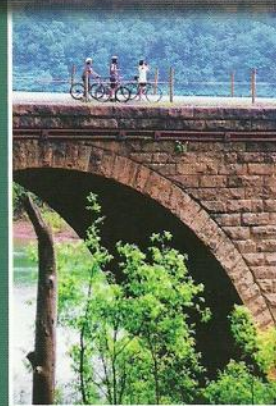
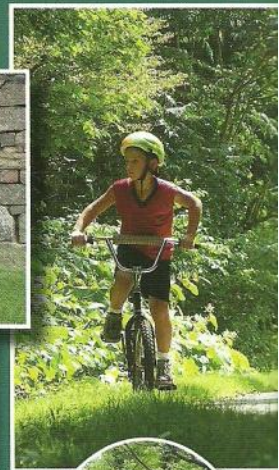
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Ghost Town, Hoodlebug & West Penn Trails

Regional Trail Guide



Revised 4/10, Located in
West-Central Pennsylvania

Basic Trail Safety

Whether you are biking, walking or running on the trails there are several safety tips all users should follow:

- Do not use trails after dark or before dawn.
- Wear brightly colored clothing to improve visibility. During hunting season wear safety orange to be easily seen. Some portions of the trails pass through State Game Lands.
- Take along a water bottle to avoid dehydration.
- Carry a cell phone, but remember that cell phone coverage is limited in some areas of the trails.
- If biking, always wear a helmet.
- Keep your bike well maintained.
- Keep to the right and pass on the left. Provide a verbal signal or use a bell to alert others when passing.
- Wearing headsets while using the trail is not recommended.
- Carry identification with you. Let others know where you are going before heading out on the trail.
- In the event of an emergency call 911.
- To report non-emergencies or trail conditions requiring attention please call (724) 463-8636 in Indiana County or (814) 472-2110 in Cambria County.



Hoodlebug Trail

Indiana to Black Lick Section

Distance: 10 miles

Surface: Asphalt, tar and chip

Designated Access Areas:

- IUP South Campus – parking is permitted at ballfield parking lots, use Rose Street bike lane to access trail.
- Floodway Park – in the Borough of Homer City.
- Red Barn Access Area – south of Homer City at the Homer Center Athletic Booster Complex.
- Saylor Park, Black Lick, PA.

Trail Highlights

The Hoodlebug Trail is a ten-mile recreation and commuter trail located in the central portion of Indiana County, Pennsylvania. The trail passes through residential, commercial and natural settings, providing direct trail access to many local residents and employees of schools, industries and small businesses.

The trail follows the abandoned Indiana Branch of the Pennsylvania Railroad between Indiana and Black Lick. Built in the 1850's, the Indiana Branch was the first railroad to be constructed in Indiana County. 'Hoodlebug' was the local nickname for the self-propelled passenger coach that ran on the line until 1940 (see photo below). The corridor was also part of the Catawba Path, a Native American trail that extended from the Carolinas to Olean, New York.

Hoodlebug Trail

Black Lick to Blairsville Section

Distance: 8 miles

Surface: Mainly Township Roads, some off-road segments

Designated Trail Access Areas:

- Saylor Park, Black Lick
- Various locations within Blairsville Borough and WyoTech Park



Trail/Bike Route Highlights

From Black Lick to Blairsville the Hoodlebug Trail is a designated bike route (not a rail-trail) which follows various township roads. Caution: The bike route contains steep stretches and portions of the township roads are heavily traveled at certain times of the day, particularly Cornell Road in the area of the Blairsville High School and the WyoTech School. This trail section should be attempted only if you are a seasoned rider, comfortable riding in traffic, and are willing to exercise caution.

West Penn Trail

Blairsville to Saltsburg

Distance: 16 miles

Surface: Asphalt, tar and chip - Hard-packed limestone dust

Designated Access Areas

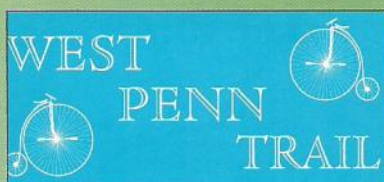
- Saltsburg
- Conemaugh Dam
- Livermore
- Newport Road Trailhead (near Blairsville)

Trail Highlights

The West Penn Trail is a 16-mile rail-trail between Avonmore and the Newport Road trailhead near Blairsville. The trail uses the grade of the 1883-1907 railroad line and currently consists of two sections: the Conemaugh River Lake and the Saltsburg sections. The Conemaugh River Lake section includes four spectacular stone arch bridges built in 1907 which offer incredible vistas of the serpentine Conemaugh River. From this section, you will catch glimpses of the old canal and railroad grades. Conemaugh Dam, operated by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, is within this section, in addition to the Tunnelview Historic Site, operated by Indiana County Parks & Trails. The Saltsburg section passes through beautiful backwoods, containing canal and railroad remnants along the Conemaugh River.

The West Penn Trail is built through an historic section of the Conemaugh River Valley. Bow Ridge is the site of the third tunnel constructed in the United States, a canal tunnel opened in 1829. Two more railroad tunnels were dug through the same ridge - all are now closed. A fourth tunnel was constructed for a hydroelectric plant, which still operates downstream of the Conemaugh Dam.

Following the disastrous St. Patrick's Day Flood of 1936, Congress authorized a series of flood control dams to protect Pittsburgh. The Conemaugh Dam, completed in 1953, was one of them. The river valley behind the dam became a virtually untouched wilderness in the ensuing half century. The abandoned canal and railroad corridors were almost forgotten. Small communities like Livermore, Fillmore, and Social Hall grew around the canal and railroad and vanished with the construction of the dam. The West Penn Trail offers exciting opportunities to relearn the history of this beautiful corridor. Historical markers along the trail feature snapshots of this previously hidden valley.



Ghost Town Trail

Black Lick to Ebensburg & Rexis Branch

Distance: 36 miles

Surface: Hard-packed limestone dust

Designated Access Areas

- Saylor Park - Black Lick, PA
- Heshbon
- Dilltown
- Wehrum
- Rexis
- Twin Rocks
- Nanty Glo
- Ebensburg

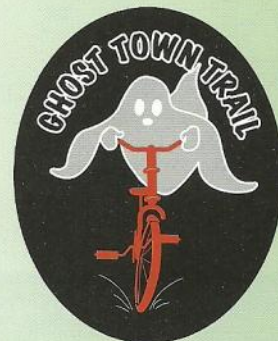
Trail Highlights

The Ghost Town Trail is constructed from finely packed limestone dust placed on a former railroad grade. The trail is generally flat with a few sections having grades of up to 3%. Trail sections with the steepest grades include portions of the Black Lick to Heshbon; Vintondale to Twin Rocks; and Nanty Glo to Ebensburg.

In 2009 two trail bridges were installed near Dilltown to complete the final missing link in the Ghost Town Trail system.

Mile markers and directional signs located along the trail will assist you in knowing where you are at, and how far it is to the next access area or attraction. Interpretive signs and historical markers are located throughout the trail to help educate and inform you about the history of the area.

Portions of the trail are located in remote areas - while we recommend taking a cell phone along, cell phone service is not always available or reliable. Scattered along the trail are picnic shelters, which provide rest stops and a place to seek protection from inclement weather. Trail conditions can change due to storms, flooding and construction. Call or write the trail managers, or visit our website for current information on trail conditions.



The Ghost Town Trail totals 36 miles in Indiana and Cambria Counties, Pennsylvania. The trail was established in 1991 when the Kovalchick Salvage Company donated 16 miles of the former Ebensburg & Blacklick Railroad. In 1993 the Cambria & Indiana Railroad donated an additional 4 miles from Rexis to White Mill Station known as the Rexis Branch.

In 2005 an additional 20 miles were added to the trail - 12 miles in Indiana County and 8 miles in Cambria County. The U.S. Department of the Interior has designated the trail as a National Recreation Trail. The trail is open year-round for hiking, bicycling, and cross-country skiing.

The Ghost Town Trail derives its name from numerous mining towns that once existed along the railroad corridor. Weh-rum, the largest of the former towns, once had 230 houses, a hotel, company store, jail and bank. Warren Delano, uncle of President Franklin Roosevelt, developed the town. Other ghost towns include Bracken, Armerford, Lackawanna #3, Scott Glenn, Webster, Beula, and Claghorn.

The Eliza Furnace, on the National Register of Historic Places, is one of Pennsylvania's best preserved iron furnaces. The furnace operated from 1846 to 1849 and is a unique relic of the Blacklick Valley's early industrial era. The Buena Vista Furnace, near the trail crossing at PA Route 56, is also located along the trail. Historical markers throughout the trail provide interpretive information about Blacklick Valley's intriguing history.

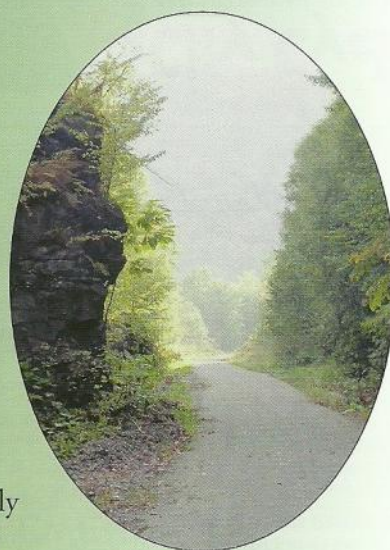


Regional Trail System Highlights

Our regional trail system continues to grow to meet the needs of our residents and an increasing number of visitors from outside our area. Since the first 16 miles of the Ghost Town Trail were opened in 1994 the regional system has grown to include nearly 65 miles of trails. Efforts are well underway to link the trail system to other trails within the region.

Our trails pass through scenic areas, historic sites, state gamelands, recreation areas, and other natural attractions.

The trails link neighborhoods, communities, schools, parks and businesses in an easily accessible route. We encourage you to support the many local businesses that provide services which can help make your visit an enjoyable one.



About the Regional Trail Guide

The regional system contained in this guide includes trails in Indiana, Cambria and Westmoreland Counties. Through partnerships with other trail organizations the goal of a fully connected regional trail system is moving closer to reality.

The Regional Trail Map shows the location of the three trails divided into six sections. Each Section Map shows major roads, public lands, parks, historic sites, and other features of interest.

Download trail maps and guide: www.indianacountyparks.org		Indiana County Parks & Trails (724) 463-8636				Cambria County Conservation & Rec. Authority (814) 472-2110			
Ghost Town Trail - Mileage Chart (approximate distances)									
	Saylor Park	Heshbon	Buena Vista	Dilltown	Wehrum	Rexis Vintondale	Twin Rocks	Nanty Glo	Ebensburg
Saylor Park		6	9	13	16	19	22	24	32
Heshbon	6		3	6	10	12	16	18	25
Buena Vista	9	3		3	7	9	13	15	22
Dilltown	13	6	3		4	6	10	12	19
Wehrum	16	10	7	4		3	6	8	15
Rexis/Vintondale	19	12	9	6	3		4	6	13
Twin Rocks	22	16	13	10	6	4		2	9
Nanty Glo	24	18	15	12	8	6	2		7
Ebensburg	32	25	22	19	15	13	9	7	
Ghost Town Trail Access Areas, Services & Elevations:									
	Parking	Water	Restroom	Food*	Pavilion **	Lodging	Elevation		
Black Lick/Saylor Park	x	x	x		x		980'	Note: Rexis Branch of the trail Trail is 4 miles in length. The Rexis Branch is not included in the chart. 	
Heshbon	x		Seasonal				1260'		
Dilltown	x	x	x	x	x	x	1350'		
Wehrum	x						1355'		
Rexis/Vintondale	x	x	x		x		1360'		
Twin Rocks	x						1660'		
Nanty Glo	x		Seasonal	x	x		1720'		
Ebensburg	x	x	x	x	x	x	2000'		
* Restaurant or food service in nearby area.									
** Other mini-pavilions are located along the trail.									
Revised: 04/10									

Ghost Town Trail Guidebook



To learn how to purchase a copy
visit www.indianacountyparks.org
Proceeds from the sale of the
Ghost Town Trail Guidebook
benefit the trail maintenance fund.

Now Available!

The guidebook is your companion to the historic, cultural and natural features along the 36-mile Ghost Town Trail.

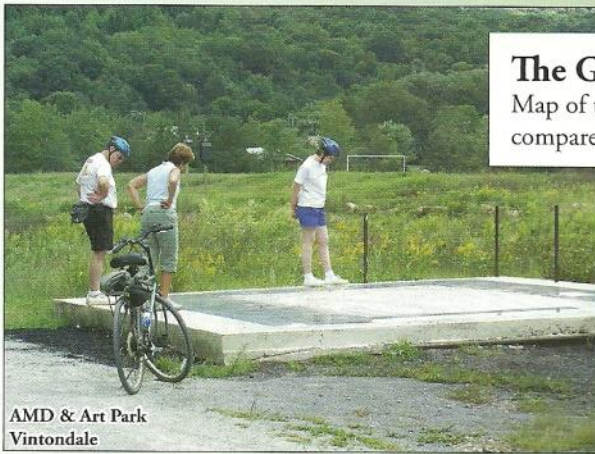
It includes maps, mileage charts, photos, historic background and illustrations of the places you'll encounter, mile by mile on the way.

You'll learn about the ghost towns, iron furnaces, lumber camps, coal mines and railroads that operated here, and the people who transformed this isolated valley into an industrial powerhouse.

No matter if you are planning a day-trip or an extended stay this is the guidebook for you.

The Ghost Town Trail Guidebook was compiled with the assistance of local historians, map makers and photographers. It is the definitive resource to the Ghost Town Trail.



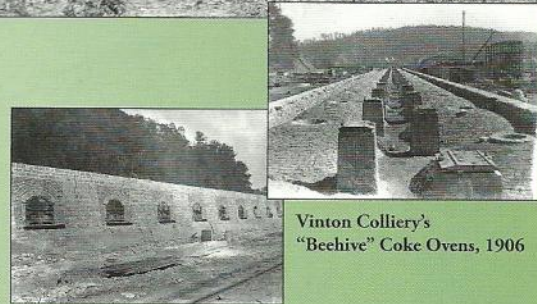


AMD & Art Park
Vintondale

The Great Map. The mosaic map replicates the 1923 Sanborn Insurance Map of the Vinton Colliery. Standing on the map, visitors can locate and compare the present landscape and buildings with those of earlier mining times.



Vinton Colliery's "Dinky" Transported Mine Supplies



Vinton Colliery's
"Beehive" Coke Ovens, 1906

For More Information

Ghost Town Trail, Indiana County Hoodlebug Trail

Indiana County Parks & Trails
1128 Blue Spruce Road
Indiana, PA 15701
724/463-8636

website: www.indianacountyparks.org



♦ Other Regional Trail Contacts

Ghost Town Trail, Cambria County

Cambria County Conservation & Recreation Authority
401 Candlelight Drive, Suite 234
Ebensburg, PA 15931
814/472-2110
website: www.co.cambria.pa.us – (follow links)

West Penn Trail

Conemaugh Valley Conservancy
PO Box 502
Hollsopple, PA 15935
814/479-7162
website: www.conemaughvalleyconservancy.org

Roaring Run Watershed Association Trail

Roaring Run Watershed Association
Box 333 Apollo, PA 15613
website: www.roaringrun.org

Westmoreland Heritage Trail

RR#12, Box 203, Greensburg, PA 15601
website: www.co.westmoreland.pa.us/parks – (follow links)

The Mine No. 6 Portal. This Miners' Memorial is an opportunity to acknowledge and reflect on the hard lives of those who worked underground. The reconstructed six-by-twelve-foot mine portal entrance stands exactly where the once-bustling Mine No. 6 Portal entrance was located. The life-sized image of men in the middle of a shift-change is etched in black polished stone.

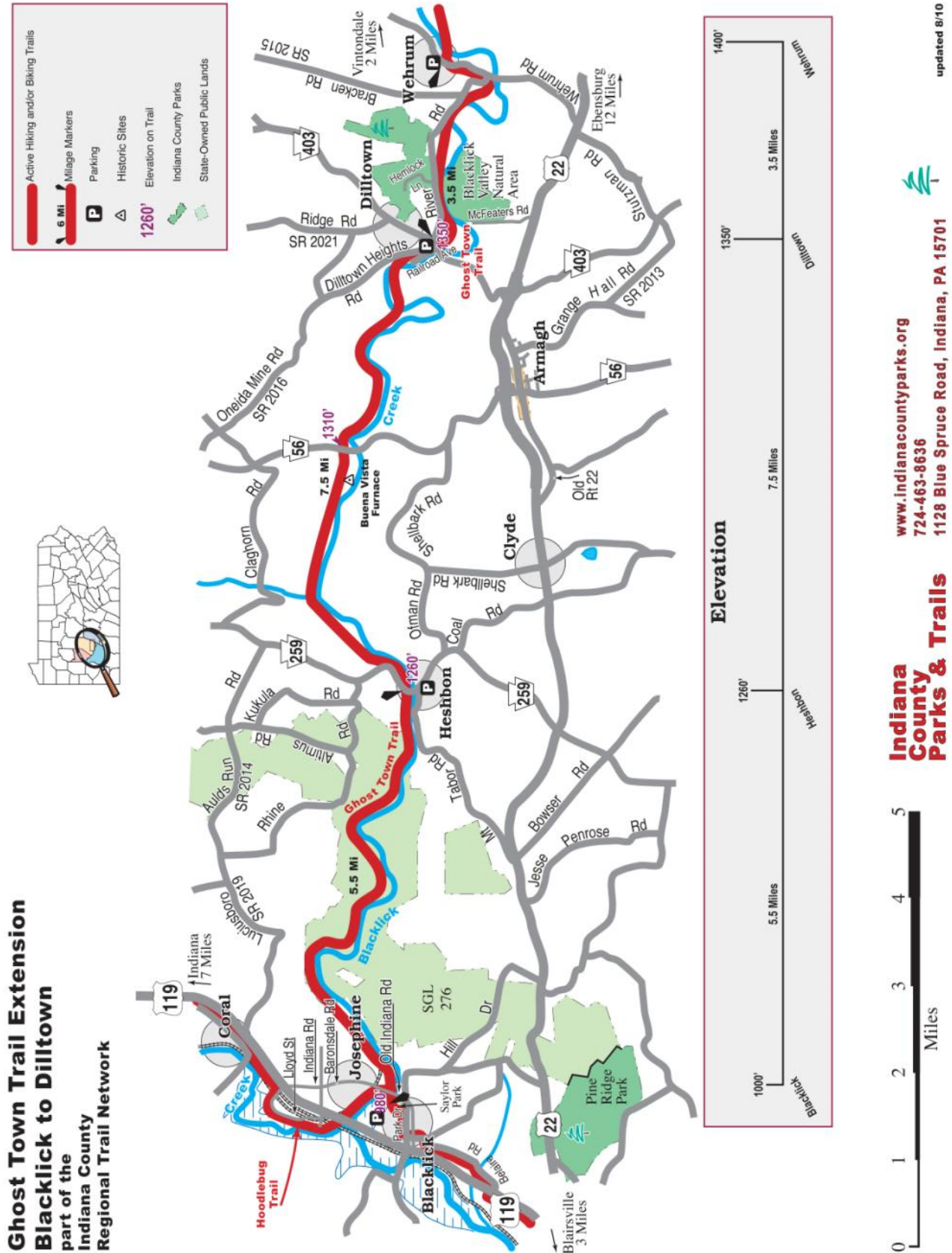


Map of Regional Trail Network



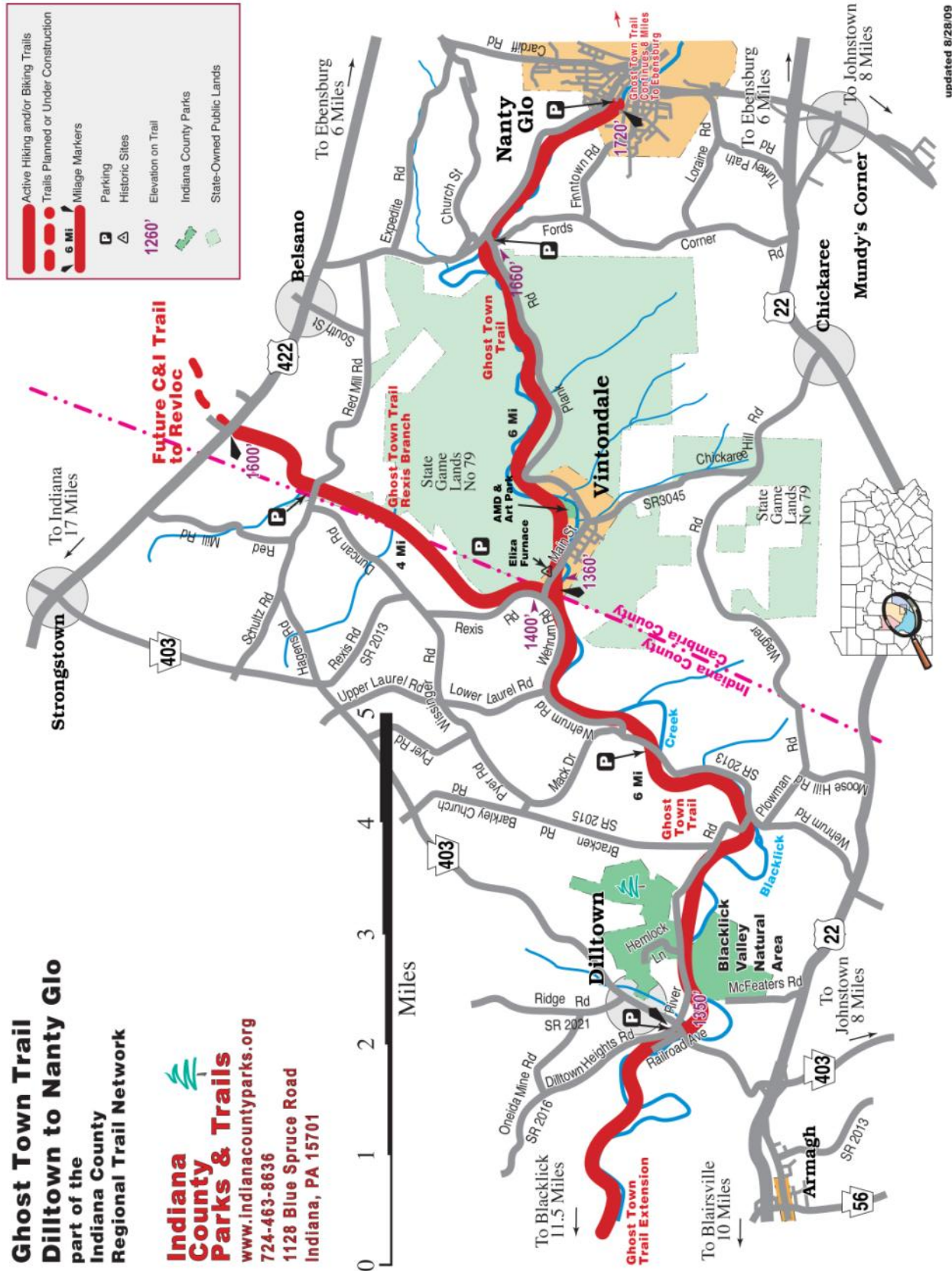
Map of Ghost Town Trail

Black Lick to Dilltown



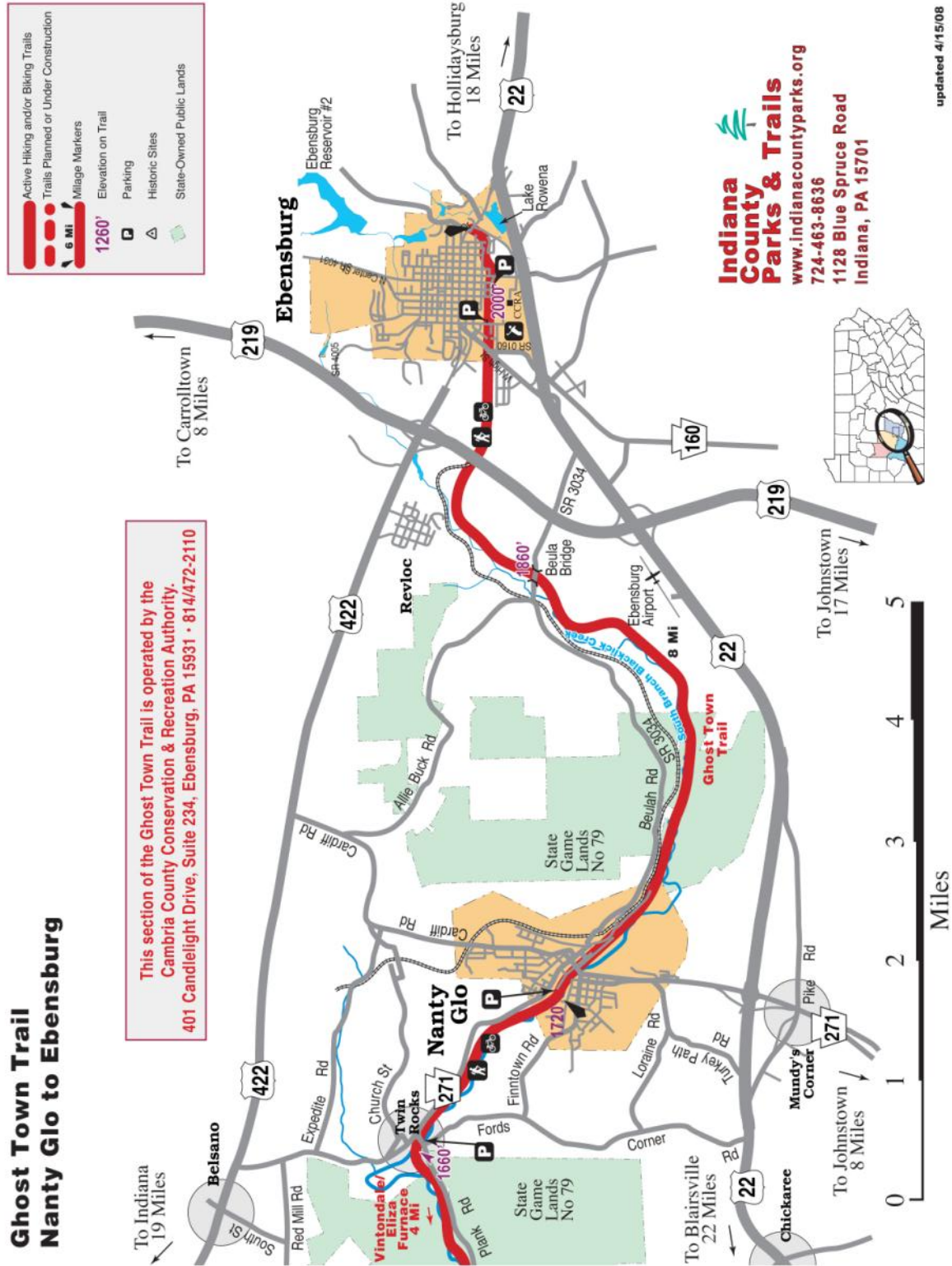
Map of Ghost Town Trail

Dilltown to Nanty Glo



Map of Ghost Town Trail

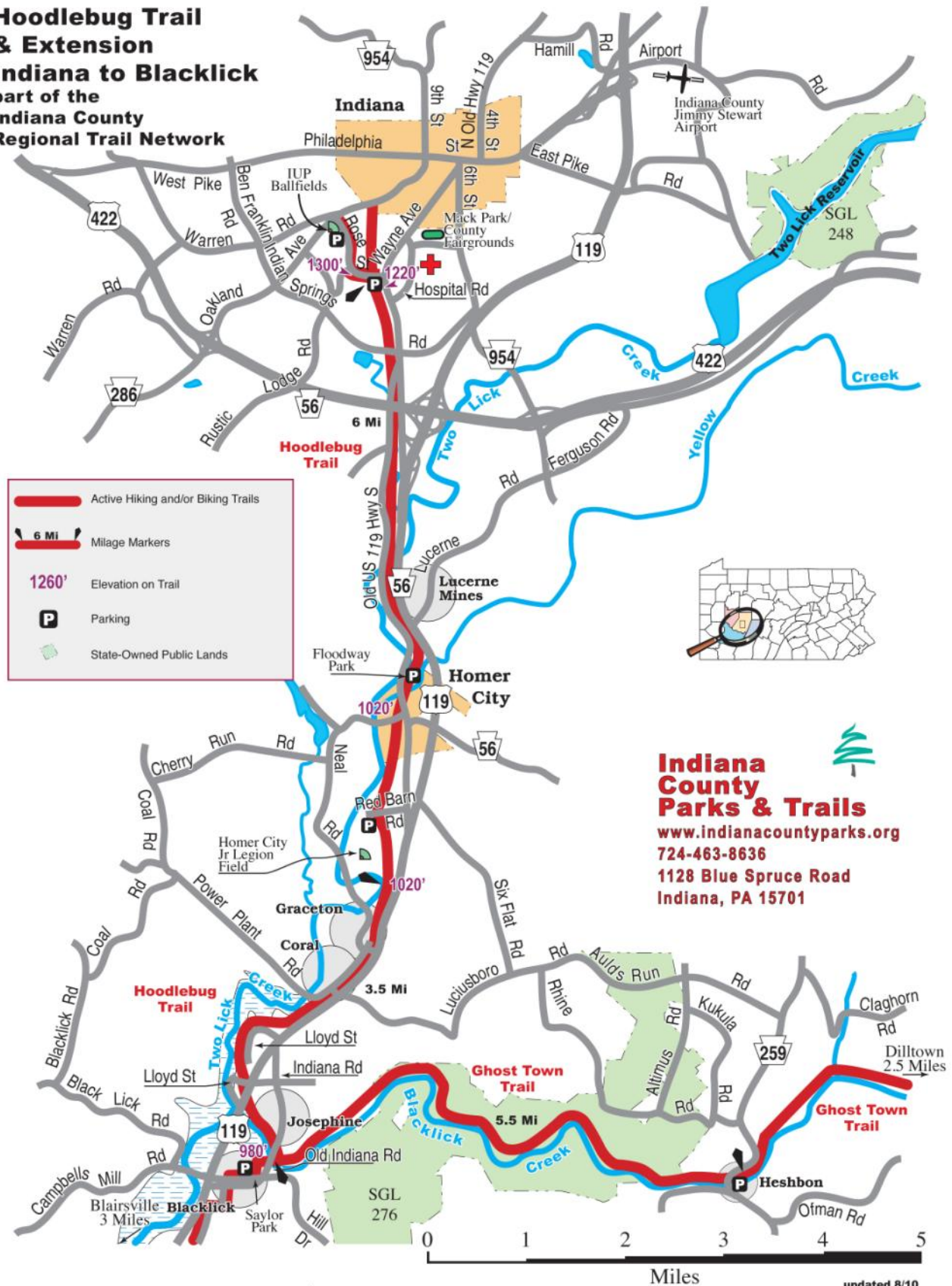
Nanty Glo to Ebensburg



Map of Hoodlebug Trail

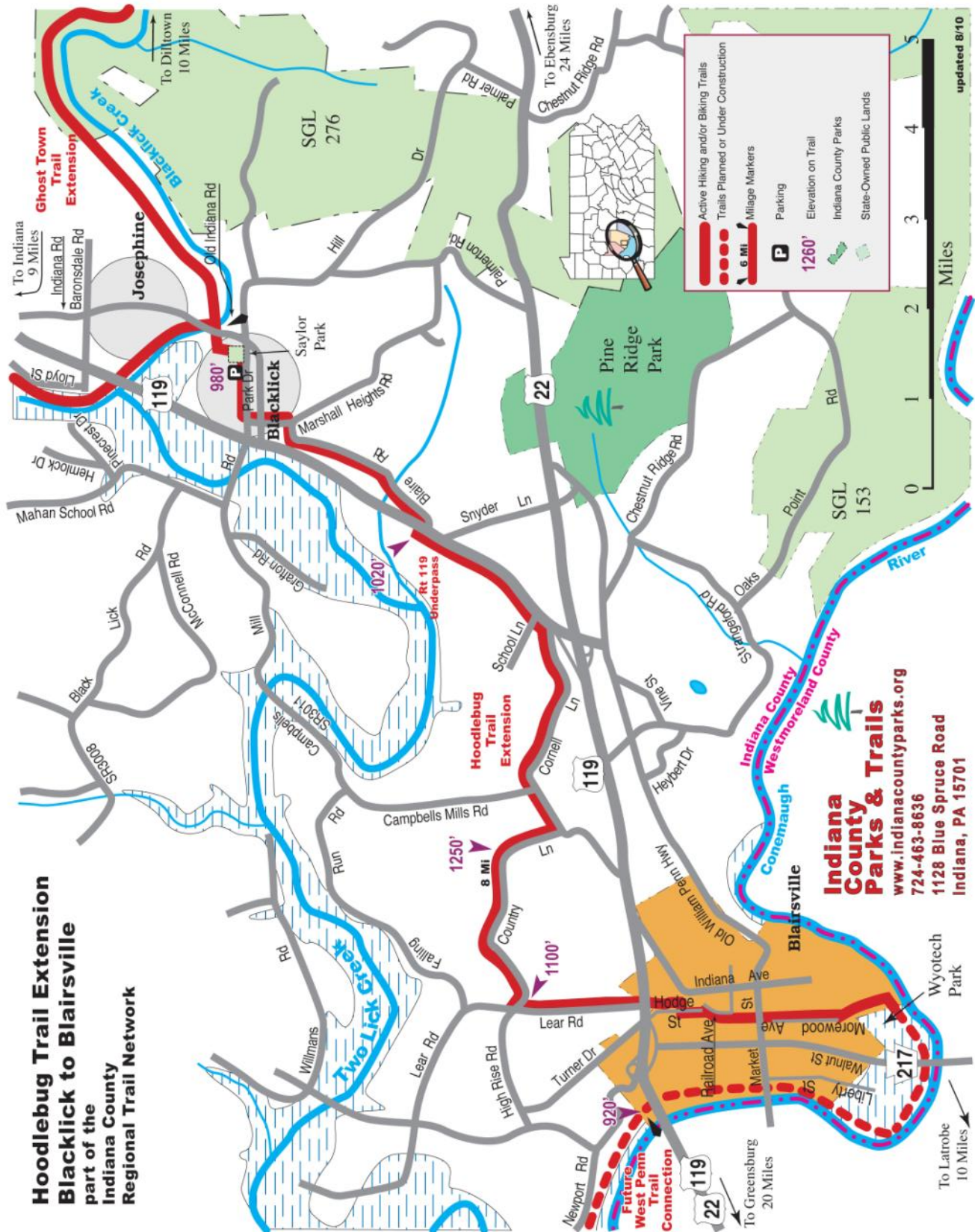
Indiana to Black Lick

**Hoodlebug Trail
& Extension
Indiana to Blacklick**
part of the
**Indiana County
Regional Trail Network**



Map of Hoodlebug Trail

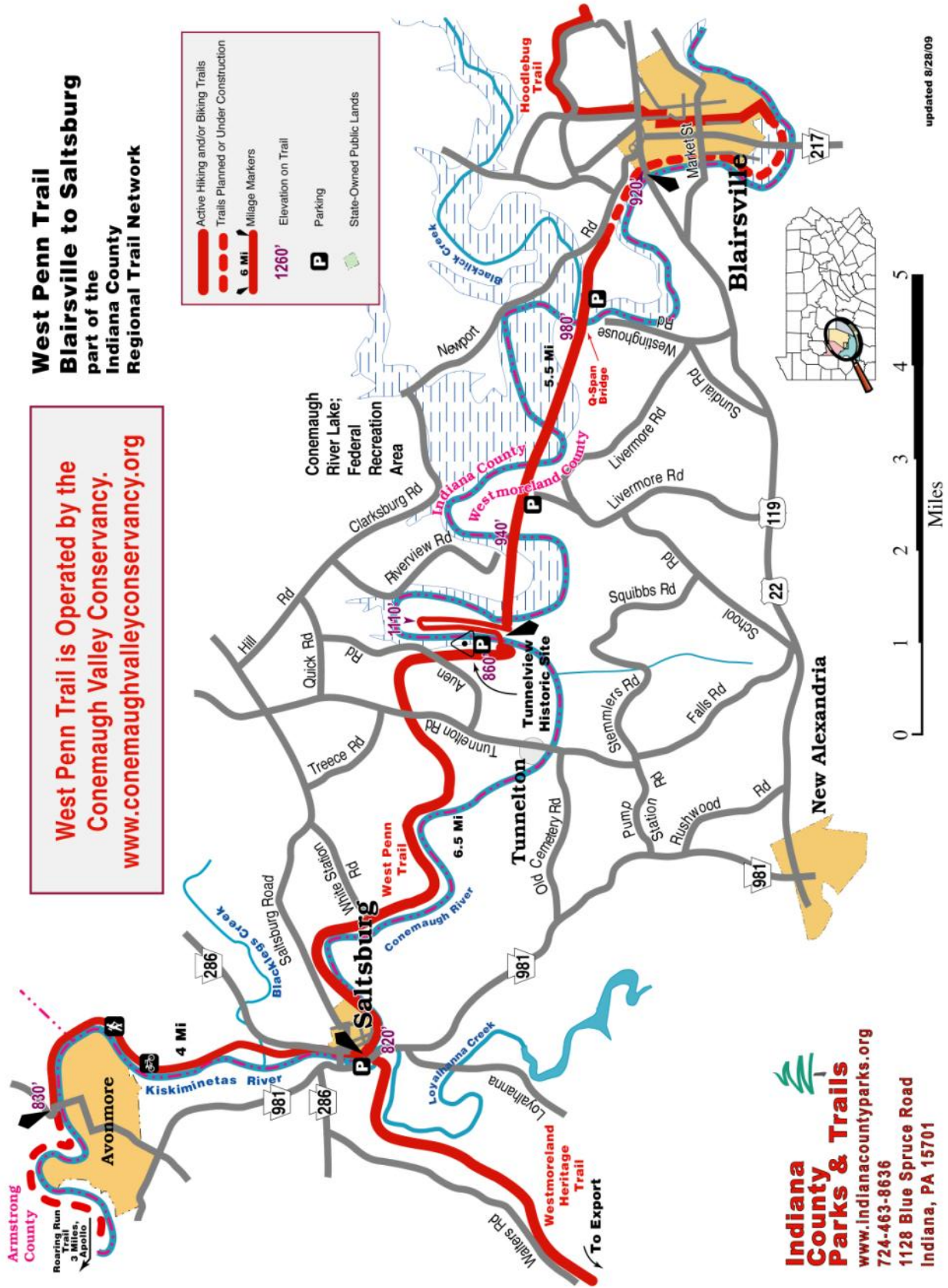
Black Lick to Blairsville



Map of West Penn Trail

**West Penn Trail
Blairsville to Saltsburg
part of the
Indiana County
Regional Trail Network**

**West Penn Trail is Operated by the
Conemaugh Valley Conservancy.
www.conemaughvalleyconservancy.org**



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